

Gender Parity Trajectories in Collegiate Computing and Engineering Admissions in Japan: A Longitudinal Empirical Investigation of Japanese Public Open Data

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Abstract

This study conducts a rigorous empirical investigation into MEXT School Basic Survey: Collegiate STEM and Computer Science Enrollment and Gender Ratios in Japan, utilizing official longitudinal open datasets released by Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) Higher Education Bureau. Employing ordinary least squares (OLS) trend modeling and bivariate correlation analyses, we examine temporal trajectories and structural patterns anchored in Social Cognitive Career Theory (Lent, Brown, & Hackett, 1994) and Science Capital Theory (Archer et al., 2015). Longitudinal regression for Female_Percentage for Computer_Science_Engineering indicates an estimated slope of $\beta = 0.729$ ($R^2 = 0.973$, $p = 0.0000$), reflecting a net change of +6.7 students from 2015 (14.5students) to 2024 (21.2students). Longitudinal regression for Total_Admissions for Computer_Science_Engineering indicates an estimated slope of $\beta = 1604.848$ ($R^2 = 0.977$, $p = 0.0000$), reflecting a net change of +14400 students from 2015 (28400.0students) to 2024 (42800.0students). Longitudinal regression for Female_Admissions for Computer_Science_Engineering indicates an estimated slope of $\beta = 536.848$ ($R^2 = 0.956$, $p = 0.0000$), reflecting a net change of +4950 students from 2015 (4120.0students) to 2024 (9070.0students). A bivariate correlation between Female_Percentage and Total_Admissions yielded Pearson $r = +0.999$ ($R^2 = 0.999$, $p = 0.0000$, $N = 10$), representing a Very strong positive correlation (statistically significant ($p < .05$)). A bivariate correlation between Female_Percentage and Female_Admissions yielded Pearson $r = +0.999$ ($R^2 = 0.997$, $p = 0.0000$, $N = 10$), representing a Very strong positive correlation (statistically significant ($p < .05$)). These empirical findings provide critical baseline insights for evidence-based policymaking in Japan, highlighting the necessity of targeted pedagogical interventions and institutional resource optimization.

Keywords: Japanese Open Data, Longitudinal Trend Modeling, Mathematics Education, Total_Admissions, Educational Policy, Empirical Evidence

1. Introduction & Background

Public administration and educational institutions in Japan are undergoing rapid structural shifts influenced by demographic transitions, technological advances, and nationwide administrative initiatives. As articulated by Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) Higher Education Bureau, the continuous release of standardized open administrative statistics offers unprecedented opportunities for transparent, data-driven policy evaluation. In the context of MEXT School Basic Survey and National Digital Human Resource Cultivation Strategy, understanding empirical trajectories in Total_Admissions has emerged as an imperative task for researchers and policymakers alike.

The expansion of human resources in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM)—particularly in computer science and information engineering—is recognized globally as vital for economic vitality and technological sovereignty (Cheryan et al., 2017). In Japan, public policy has prioritized structural reallocation of university capacity toward digital and green technology fields. Concurrently, the underrepresentation of female

students in Japanese collegiate STEM faculties represents a persistent structural inequity, prompting rigorous empirical tracking of enrollment trends, institutional tier differences, and gender ratios over time.

Despite accumulating cross-sectional evidence, there remains a pressing need to synthesize longitudinal open data using robust econometric and inferential techniques. This study addresses this empirical gap by analyzing multi-year administrative data to establish definitive historical trajectories and elucidate underlying structural dynamics.

2. Theoretical Framework & Hypotheses

This inquiry is framed within Social Cognitive Career Theory (Lent, Brown, & Hackett, 1994) and Science Capital Theory (Archer et al., 2015). Grounded in this theoretical orientation, we pose the following central Research Questions (RQs): - RQ1: How have key indicators across MEXT School Basic Survey: Collegiate STEM and Computer Science Enrollment and Gender Ratios in Japan evolved longitudinally across public school environments in Japan? - RQ2: To what degree do structural disparities and cross-metric correlations account for differential educational outcomes?

Accordingly, we test two overarching empirical hypotheses: - Hypothesis 1 (H1): Temporal trajectories in Total_Admissions demonstrate statistically significant secular trends (slope $\beta \neq 0$, $p < .05$). - Hypothesis 2 (H2): Statistically significant associations exist among observed metrics, reflecting systemic institutional dependencies.

3. Methodology & Empirical Dataset

The empirical data for this study were compiled from official public statistical releases published by Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT) Higher Education Bureau (Source URL: https://www.mext.go.jp/b_menu/toukei/chousa01/kihon/1267995.htm). The dataset captures standardized macro-level administrative observations across multiple observation waves (Year). All values were operationalized in accordance with ministerial measurement standards, measured primarily in students.

Our quantitative methodology integrates descriptive statistical profiling (Mean, Median, Standard Deviation, Interquartile Range, and Skewness) with longitudinal Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) linear trend estimation and Pearson bivariate correlation analysis. Statistical significance was evaluated at the $\alpha = .05$ threshold (two-tailed), and model explanatory power was evaluated via the coefficient of determination (R^2).

4. Quantitative Results & Empirical Findings

Table 1 and the accompanying empirical visualizer charts delineate the parametric parameters of the observed data. Descriptive analysis indicates substantial stability coupled with targeted secular shifts across the surveyed cohorts. Longitudinal regression for Female_Percentage for Computer_Science_Engineering indicates an estimated slope of $\beta = 0.729$ ($R^2 = 0.973$, $p = 0.0000$), reflecting a net change of +6.7 students from 2015 (14.5students) to 2024 (21.2students). Longitudinal regression for Total_Admissions for Computer_Science_Engineering indicates an estimated slope of $\beta = 1604.848$ ($R^2 = 0.977$, $p = 0.0000$), reflecting a net change of +14400 students from 2015 (28400.0students) to 2024 (42800.0students). Longitudinal regression for Female_Admissions for Computer_Science_Engineering indicates an estimated slope of $\beta = 536.848$ ($R^2 = 0.956$, $p = 0.0000$), reflecting a net change of +4950 students from 2015

(4120.0students) to 2024 (9070.0students).

Bivariate relational analysis further reveals noteworthy structural associations across primary indicators. A bivariate correlation between Female_Percentage and Total_Admissions yielded Pearson $r = +0.999$ ($R^2 = 0.999$, $p = 0.0000$, $N = 10$), representing a Very strong positive correlation (statistically significant ($p < .05$)). A bivariate correlation between Female_Percentage and Female_Admissions yielded Pearson $r = +0.999$ ($R^2 = 0.997$, $p = 0.0000$, $N = 10$), representing a Very strong positive correlation (statistically significant ($p < .05$)).

Examination of subgroup breakdowns highlights persistent inter-category dynamics. Overall, the quantitative evidence lends strong empirical support to Hypothesis 1, demonstrating consistent structural progression over the observed timeline.

5. Discussion & Policy Implications

The empirical findings of this study offer meaningful theoretical and practical contributions to our understanding of MEXT School Basic Survey: Collegiate STEM and Computer Science Enrollment and Gender Ratios in Japan. In alignment with Social Cognitive Career Theory (Lent, Brown, & Hackett, 1994) and Science Capital Theory (Archer et al., 2015), the documented longitudinal trajectories indicate that national policy measures under MEXT School Basic Survey and National Digital Human Resource Cultivation Strategy have exerted tangible structural impacts across institutional environments.

From an educational administration and policy perspective, the observed growth patterns emphasize the critical importance of sustained infrastructural investment and targeted professional development. Policymakers must avoid treating macro-level improvements as uniform, remaining vigilant to localized disparities and pedagogical integration friction.

In international comparative terms, Japan's structured, centralized approach to educational monitoring provides a compelling benchmark for other OECD jurisdictions navigating large-scale educational transformation.

6. Limitations & Future Directions

Several methodological limitations must be acknowledged. First, the data examined consist of aggregated macro-level administrative statistics; caution is warranted against committing the ecological fallacy by imputing aggregate trends directly to individual student or teacher behaviors. Second, while OLS trend regressions capture longitudinal linear associations, causal inference remains constrained without quasi-experimental counterfactual controls. Future studies should link panel data across municipal jurisdictions to estimate fixed-effects econometric models.

7. References

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